Process & Decision Documentation

A2: Midterm Game

GBDA 302

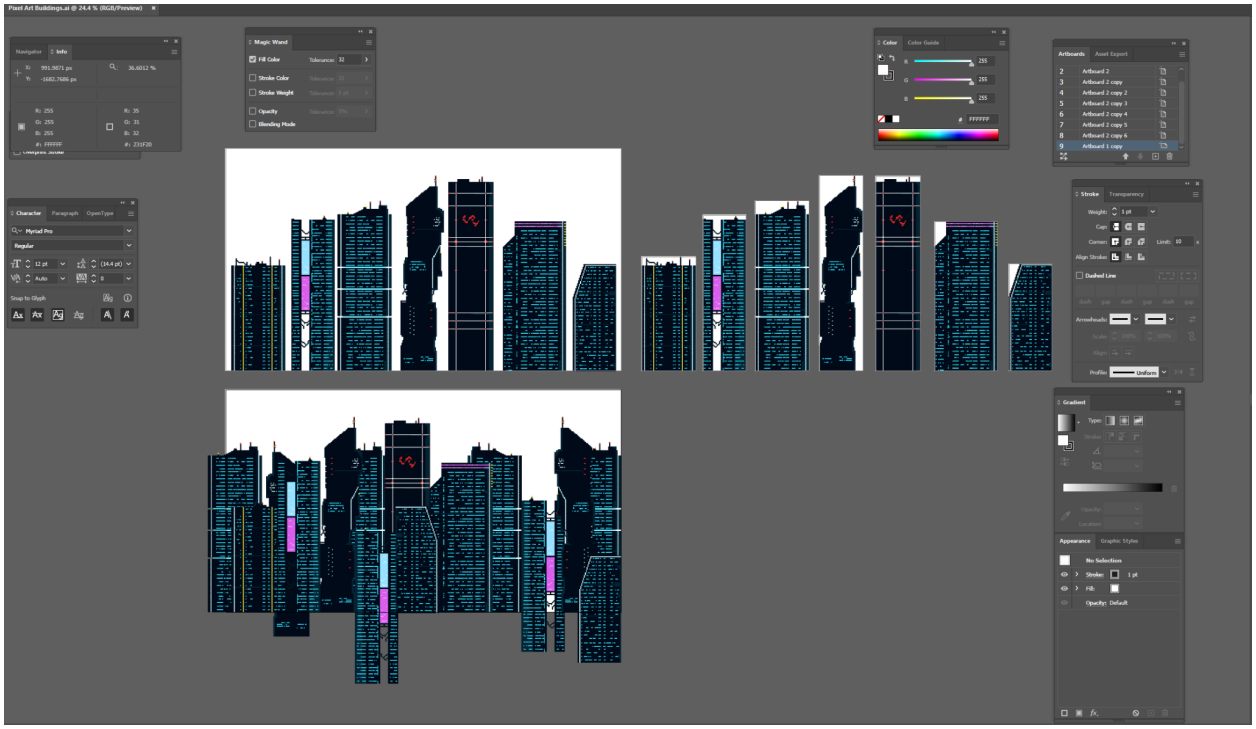
March 13, 2026

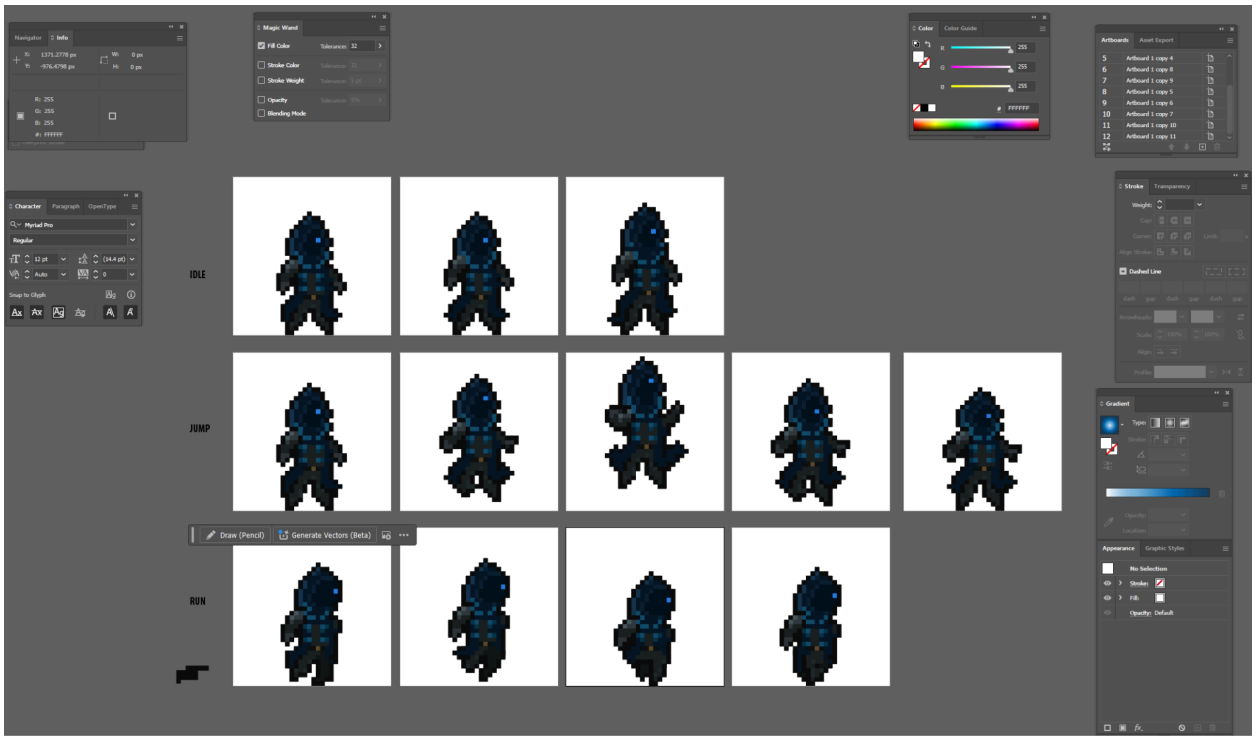
Emerson Sanchez, Jason Pham, Cohen Peters, Cameron Emsley-Drummond

Group 9A

Process Overview Visualization

Below is a description of our group's design process for A2.





A2_Group9A_MidTermGame

EXPLORER

A2_GROUP9A_MIDTERMGAME

- A2_Group9A_MidTermGame
  - assets
  - libraries
  - .gitattributes
  - index.html
  - jsconfig.json
  - README.md
  - sketch.js
  - style.css

OUTLINE

TIMELINE

sketch.js ● | README.md

A2_Group9A_MidTermGame > sketch.js > ...

You, 32 minutes ago | 1 author (You)

```javascript
// ═══════════════════════════════════════════════════════════════
// DATA BREACH — cyberpunk platformer
// p5.js · 800 × 450 (Scaled) · hand-designed static level      You, 32 minutes ago • Uncommitted changes
// ═══════════════════════════════════════════════════════════════

// ── CONSTANTS ──────────────────────────────────────────────
const GRAVITY    = 1.0;
const MOVE_SPEED = 5.5;
const JUMP_FORCE = -15;
const TERM_VEL   = 22;
const WORLD_W    = 4800;

const FOCUS_RADIUS         = 280;
const FOCUS_FADE_FRAMES    = 90;   // 1.5s fade on release
const FOCUS_COOLDOWN_FRAMES = 210; // 3.5s cooldown before reuse

const INTRO_NORMAL_F = 60;
const INTRO_SHAKE_F  = 30;
const INTRO_FLASH_F  = 24;

const RAIN_COUNT = 50;
const MOTE_COUNT = 15;

const COYOTE_FRAMES     = 7;
const JUMP_CUT_MULT     = 0.42;
const DOUBLE_JUMP_FORCE = -10;

const LIGHT_SOURCES = [
  { x: 200,  y: 0, w: 300, h: 450, phase: 0.0,  speed: 0.038 },
  { x: 850,  y: 0, w: 240, h: 450, phase: 2.1,  speed: 0.055 },
  { x: 1480, y: 0, w: 320, h: 450, phase: 1.4,  speed: 0.031 },
  { x: 2200, y: 0, w: 260, h: 450, phase: 0.7,  speed: 0.048 },
  { x: 3000, y: 0, w: 280, h: 450, phase: 1.9,  speed: 0.042 },
  { x: 3800, y: 0, w: 350, h: 450, phase: 0.3,  speed: 0.036 },
];

const GLARE_ZONES = [
  { x: 700,  w: 350, intensity: 1.4 },
  { x: 2600, w: 600, intensity: 3.0 },
  { x: 3800, w: 900, intensity: 3.8 },
];

const DARK_ZONES = [
  { x: 1700, w: 450, intensity: 0.72 },
  { x: 4050, w: 350, intensity: 0.82 },
];

const WIN_BTN = { x: 310, y: 378, w: 180, h: 40 };

const DEATH_SHAKE_FRAMES = 18;
const DEATH_FLASH_FRAMES = 14;
const FOCUS_FLASH_FRAMES = 10;
```

Claude Code

Past Conversations

Claude Code

Ready to code?
Let's write something worth deploying.

Prefer the Terminal experience? Switch back in Settings.

⌘ Esc to focus or unfocus Claude

Ask before ed... sketch...

A2_Group9A_MidTermGame main | Launchpad | 0 0 | You, 32 minutes ago | Ln 3, Col 30 | Spaces: 2 | UTF-8 | LF | JavaScript | Go Live | Prettier

A2_Group9A_MidTermGame

EXPLORER

A2_GROUP9A_MIDTERMGAME

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OUTLINE

TIMELINE

sketch.js | index.html | README.md

A2_Group9A_MidTermGame > README.md > ## Interaction Instructions

```md
## Description

This project is a 2D side-scrolling platformer set in a cyberpunk city at night. The player controls Jamie, a data hacker with low vision, navigating across glowing neon platforms while dodging patrolling enemies, laser tripwires, and spike traps to reach the goal at the end of the level.

The core design explores low vision as a gameplay mechanic — the world is intentionally dark and hard to read. Some zones are overexposed with harsh glare, others are near pitch-black. Jamie's echolocation ability briefly reveals nearby platforms and hazards, but requires standing still and carries a cooldown, creating tension between exploring carefully and moving quickly. The visual design is inspired by cyberpunk noir aesthetics: deep blacks, electric neons, and rain-soaked city silhouettes.

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## Interaction Instructions

Press `START GAME` on the title screen using `Enter` or by clicking the button with the mouse.

- Use `Left` / `Right` arrow keys or `A` / `D` to move
- Press `Up`, `W`, or `Space` to jump
- Press jump again mid-air for a **double jump**
- Hold `F` while standing still on the ground to activate **Echolocation** — highlights nearby platforms and enemies with a cyan glow for 1.5 seconds, then enters a 3.5-second cooldown

**Visual & audio feedback to watch for:**

- A pulsing cyan ring radiates outward from Jamie when echolocation activates
- A small arc indicator below Jamie fills as the echolocation cooldown refills
- The neon progress bar at the top of the screen shows how far through the level you are
- Cyan glowing pillars mark checkpoints — walk through them to save your respawn point
- A spinning diamond pickup temporarily restores full platform visibility for 5 seconds
- A creeping darkness wall begins chasing you midway through the level — keep moving
- Red screen flash and screenshake signal when Jamie is hit

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## Assets

- `assets/images/Buildings/Pixel Art Buildings-02.png` through `-08.png` (original artwork, created by Emerson)
- `assets/images/JAMIE/IDLE/Jamie_IDLE_1-3.png` (original artwork, created by Emerson)
- `assets/images/JAMIE/RUN/Jamie_RUN_1-4.png` (original artwork, created by Emerson)
- `assets/images/JAMIE/JUMP/Jamie_JUMP_1-5.png` (original artwork, created by Emerson)
- `assets/sounds/nikitakondrashev-cyberpunk-437545.mp3` — background music (Kondrashev, 2025)
- `assets/sounds/Jump.mp3` — jump sound effect (copyright free)
- `assets/sounds/Dash.mp3` — double jump sound effect (copyright free)
- `assets/sounds/Focus.mp3` — echolocation activation sound effect (copyright free)
- `assets/sounds/Breach(death).mp3` — death sound effect (copyright free)
- `assets/sounds/Explosion then power down.mp3` — goal reached sound effect (copyright free)

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## References
```

Claude Code

Past Conversations

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Ask before ... README...

A2_Group9A_MidTermGame main | Launchpad | 0 0 | You, 1 hour ago | Jason Pham (32 minutes ago) | Ln 26, Col 37 | Spaces: 4 | UTF-8 | LF | Markdown | Go Live | Prettier

A2_Group9A_MidTermGame

EXPLORER

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OUTLINE

TIMELINE

sketch.js | README.md | style.css

A2_Group9A_MidTermGame > sketch.js > ...

```js
// ── Particle initialisation ──────────────────────────────────────
function initParticles() {
  rain  = [];
  motes = [];
  for (let i = 0; i < RAIN_COUNT; i++) {
    rain.push({ x: random(width + 40), y: random(-20, height),
                speed: random(5, 9), len: random(12, 22), alpha: random(15, 40) });
  }
  for (let i = 0; i < MOTE_COUNT; i++) {
    motes.push({ x: random(width), y: random(height),
                 vx: random(-0.3, 0.3), vy: random(-0.6, -0.15),
                 size: random(1.5, 3), alpha: random(60, 160), pink: random() > 0.6 });
  }
}

// ═══════════════════════════════════════════════════════════════════
//  MAIN LOOP
// ═══════════════════════════════════════════════════════════════════

function draw() {
  if (gameState === "start") { drawStartScreen(); return; }
  if (gameState === "win")   { drawWinScreen();   return; }

  if (gameState === "winning") {
    winTimer++;
    background(12, 8, 20);
    drawParallax(true);
    push(); translate(-camX, 0);
    drawLights(); drawPlatforms(); drawMovingPlatforms();
    drawGoal(); drawEnemies();
    pop();
    updateParticles(); drawParticles();
    drawScanlines(); drawVignette();
    let portalSX = goal.x + goal.w / 2 - camX;
    let portalSY = goal.y + goal.h / 2;
    let r    = map(winTimer, 0, 28, 0, dist(0, 0, width, height) * 1.1);
    let alph = winTimer < 18 ? map(winTimer, 0, 18, 0, 230) : 230;
    noStroke(); fill(0, 210, 255, constrain(alph, 0, 255));
    ellipse(portalSX, portalSY, r * 2, r * 2);
    if (winTimer >= 34) gameState = "win";
    return;
  }

  updatePlayer();
  updateMovingPlatforms();
  updateCamera();

  if (gameState === "intro") {
    introTimer++;
    drawIntroScene();
    if (introTimer >= INTRO_NORMAL_F + INTRO_SHAKE_F + INTRO_FLASH_F) gameState = "play";
    return;
```

Claude Code

Past Conversations

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A2_Group9A_MidTermGame main | Launchpad | 0 0 | You, 33 minutes ago | Ln 3, Col 30 | Spaces: 2 | UTF-8 | LF | JavaScript | Go Live | Prettier

Phase 1:

Ideation & Setup (Feb 27, 2026)

- Emerson (Project Lead) confirmed the disability topic and locked in roles for dev and design.
- Core game concept agreed upon by the group.
- GitHub repository created by Jason (Main Dev); branches established.
- The group continued communication through an Instagram group chat and shared documents.

Phase 2:

Development (Feb 27 – Mar 3, 2026)

- Jason led all p5.js development as Main Dev.
- Cohen (Design Lead) established the visual design and overall feel of the game.
- Cameron (Writing Lead) handled in-game text and narrative framing of the disability topic.
- Emerson coordinated task progress and kept the team on track against milestones.
- All new features are developed on separate branches and reviewed before merging to main.
- Jason built the following features on Mar 4: Core Gameplay Prompt (game loop foundation), Low vision world effect (disability simulation), focus mechanic, Intro sequence, Win condition, level endpoint, and Visual + Increased Difficulty pass.

Phase 3:

Debugging & Internal Testing (Mar 4, 2026)

- Team tested the build together to identify bugs and usability issues.
- Known bugs fixed, and the game brought to 70-80% polish.
- Build confirmed playable from start to finish before external playtesting. Internal testing done by the team before the Mar 5 playtesting session.

Phase 4:

Playtesting (Mar 5, 2026)

- All members attended the in-class playtesting session (mandatory attendance).

- One member introduced the game concept to playtesters.
- Feedback recorded from peers and instructors on mechanics, clarity, and empathy framing.
- Three concrete changes were identified for the Showcase based on observations.
- Jason committed "Added Jamie + Ideation," Code cleanup, "Final Iteration before showcase," and "I lied - Before Showcase" on Mar 5, reflecting last-minute additions and cleanup before the in-class session.

Phase 5:
Post-Playtesting Fixes (Mar 7 – Mar 10, 2026)

- All playtest feedback compiled and prioritized; team agreed on what to fix vs. cut (Mar 7).
- Prioritized bugs and feedback addressed; fixes merged and tested (Mar 10).
- Jason committed Playtesting Revisions 1 on Mar 10, addressing feedback from the Mar 5 session.

Phase 6:
Final Build & Documentation (Mar 11, 2026)

- Full playable game completed.
- Process documentation finalized.
- The GitHub Pages link confirmed working in Google Chrome.
- Cohen (AI Verification) confirmed all GenAI usage was properly documented.
- Jason committed Checkpoints + Visibility and Final tweaks on Mar 11, completing the checkpoint system and final visual/mechanic adjustments.

Phase 7:
Polish, Showcase & Submission (Mar 12, 2026)

- Minor bug fixes and last touches completed in the morning before class.
- All members attended the Mid-Term Showcase (mandatory attendance).

- Each group member stayed for the full assigned timeslot, observed other groups, and asked questions.
- GitHub repo URL and GitHub Pages link submitted on LEARN by Jason before 11:59 PM.
- Jason committed Checkpoint quick fix and Minor Bug Fixes on Mar 11 (9 hours before showcase), addressing the last issues found during final review.

Project/Assignment Decisions

Our group made several key decisions throughout the development of A2 that shaped the final product.

Decision 1 — Concept Development

What & Why	With the concepts in place, the team worked on refining the basic mechanics and the important mechanics that the game required.
Who	The entire team was involved in this process to ensure clear information was passed through the project.
Effect it had in our game	This decision was important to our game development as it served as a keystone in creating a basic structure of what the game would represent for low-visioned audiences.

Decision 2. — Refining Basic Mechanics

What & Why	With the concepts in place, the team worked on refining the basic mechanics and the important mechanics that the game required.
Who	The entire team was involved in this process to ensure that the mechanics were implemented accurately and were manageable within our scope.
Effect it had in our game	This decision ensured that our game had mechanics that perfectly represented our disability and provided the player with an engaging experience.

Decision 3. — Concept Art

What & Why	Team members worked on the concept art for the game to get a basic structure on how the game will look visually.
Who	Cohen and Cameron were responsible in creating the basic structure for the visual identity of our game.
Effect it had in our game	This decision ensured that our game's visual identity was consistent and also catered to our given disability, as it made sure that all assets were visually clear.

Decision 4. — Basic Wireframing

What & Why	Basic wireframing/blocking was created in the first stages of development as it created a basic framework on where assets, elements, or objects would be placed in our game.
Who	Jason was responsible for the creation of the basic framework of the game.
Effect it had in our game	This decision ensured that the team had a basic guideline on how the game would play out and gave each member a small playtest to provide any criticism.

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Decision 5. — Basic Wireframing

What & Why	Each team member had to play the game in each iteration of its development, which removed some bias from having one person playtest.
Who	Each team member was responsible for playing the game in each iteration.
Effect it had in our game	This decision had an impact on our game as it gave us real-time feedback that we were able to fix quickly, and provided consistent criticism that would not have been covered in the official playtesting date.

Role-Based Process Evidence

Entry 1	
Name	**Emerson Sanchez**
Role(s)	Project Lead, Designer (Shadow), Writer (Shadow)
Primary responsibility	Project coordination, milestone tracking, and keeping the team aligned on timelines
Goal of Work Session	Project coordination; kept the team on track against the milestone schedule from the charter, facilitating decisions when there was disagreement, and ensuring every member knew their next steps at each phase of A2. As Project Lead, I was responsible for flagging risks early and redistributing work if any member fell behind.
Tools, Resources, or Inputs Used	• Instagram group chat for coordination • Group Charter milestone schedule • Teammates' progress updates • Group Charter milestone schedule and shared task documents

Entry 1 — (GenAI Documentation)	
Name	**Emerson Sanchez**
Date Used	February 27, 2026
Tool Disclosure	ChatGPT (5.2). Transcript: https://chatgpt.com/share/69b231a8-1a00-8004-a7cb-c62df895a66f

Purpose of Use	To develop the cyberpunk visual theme and narrative concept for the game, adapting the low visibility mechanic into a sci-fi setting.
Summary of Interaction	Reframed the jungle low-visibility concept into a cyberpunk setting while keeping the same platformer mechanics and focus ability. ChatGPT generated the story of Jamie and Charles Abalask, the cyberpunk visual theme (neon palette, pixel art, glitching architecture), the framing of low vision as "information blindness / digital interference," and platforming ideas such as data voids, laser grids, and holographic platforms.
Human Decision Point(s)	The group adopted the cyberpunk theme and the Jamie character. All puzzle mechanics suggested by ChatGPT (node connection, circuit rotation, firewall bypass) were discarded - the game stayed as a pure platformer within scope. The focus mechanic was also adjusted: ChatGPT suggested full player immobility while focusing, but the final game changed this so it is usable only while standing still on a platform.
Integrity & Verification Note:	The concept was evaluated against course requirements to confirm the low visibility disability was still authentically represented through the cyberpunk framing rather than erased by it. The group confirmed the focus mechanic still communicated low vision as a limited, tiring resource.
Scope of GenAI Use:	ChatGPT only contributed the thematic and narrative concept. All code, mechanics implementation, visual assets, and gameplay iteration were handled independently.
Limitations or Misfires:	The puzzle mechanics proposed were entirely out of scope and discarded. The full narrative (Abalask, The Vault, The Core) was not implemented beyond the character name Jamie.

Summary of Process (Human + Tool)	I set up role selection and confirmed responsibilities at the start of A2, consistent with my approach in A1. I coordinated the two mandatory attendance dates (Mar 5 playtesting, Mar 12 showcase) and kept the group aligned on the milestone deadlines outlined in the charter - from ideation complete by Feb 27 through to the final submission on Mar 12. I monitored progress across Jason's development work, Cohen's design output, and Cameron's written content to make sure no task was left behind, and facilitated group decisions when direction needed to be confirmed.
Decision Points & Trade-offs	As Project Lead, I was responsible for deciding when to flag a timeline risk and when to redistribute work between members. The charter specified that shadow roles exist to cover primary roles if anyone was overwhelmed, so key decisions included whether to escalate any task to a shadow role and how to balance the team's attention between development-heavy work and documentation ahead of the submission deadline.
Verification & Judgement	I verified progress by checking in with teammates through the Instagram group chat and referencing the milestone schedule in the charter. I confirmed all members were aware of and committed to the two mandatory attendance dates, and flagged the charter's note that short-term absences cannot be used to excuse these sessions.
Limitations, Dead Ends, or Open Questions	The concept development phase took a bit longer than expected. Although ChatGPT’s results were fairly detailed, it left a lot of gaps between our disability and the mechanics that represented it. Fixing these issues, along with refining its output, took a bit of time in our project, but it allowed us to pinpoint issues earlier rather than in the development itself.

Entry 2	
Name	**Jason Pham**
Role(s)	Main Dev, Designer (Shadow)
Primary responsibility	All p5.js development, GitHub repository ownership, branch management, and final submission
Goal of Work Session	My goal was to build the full p5.js game from scratch. I planned each phase myself, prompt engineered GenAI to handle the implementation, and then tested, bug fixed, and refined everything on my own before committing.
Role-Based Process Evidence	● Set up the GitHub repo and branch structure ● Prompt engineered the core platformer, low vision effect, and focus mechanic phase by phase ● Built the intro sequence, win condition, and level endpoint with the group in-person ● Prompted and refined the Visual + Increased Difficulty pass (moving platforms, enemies, wall-jump, variable jump height) ● Manually added Jamie sprites, spike and laser traps, dash mechanic, WASD controls, and procedural level generator in Added Jamie + Ideation ● Prompted and refined Final Iteration before showcase (enemy stacking, updated focus mechanic), done by group online ● Committed Playtesting Revisions 1 after Mar 5 session, replacing procedural generator with a static hand-designed level ● Finished with Checkpoints + Visibility, Final tweaks, Checkpoint quick fix, and Minor Bug Fixes on Mar 11 before showcase
Tools, Resources, or Inputs Used	● p5.js ● Visual Studio Code ● GitHub / GitHub Pages ● Web browser for testing and debugging ● Cohen's design specs and assets ● GenAI (coding support)

Entry 2 — (GenAI Documentation)	
Name	**Jason Pham**
Date Used	During development of A2 (Mar 4–5 and Mar 10, 2026)
Tool Disclosure	Claude Sonnet 4.6 / Opus 4.6 (Anthropic)
Purpose of Use	Used GenAI to assist with: ● Building the base platformer (Core Gameplay Prompt) ● Creating the low vision world effect ● Building the focus mechanic with cooldown ● Visual + Increased Difficulty pass (moving platforms, enemies, wall-jump mechanic, variable jump height) ● Final Iteration before showcase refinements (enemy stacking, updated focus mechanic)
Summary of Interaction	● Core Gameplay Prompt (Mar 4) - base platformer with gravity, collision, and arrow key controls on an 800x450 canvas with 7 platforms ● Low vision world effect (Mar 4) - prompted to create the effect, then I bug fixed and tested it. Platforms render at 0.2–0.3 opacity, dark radial vignette, and 2–3 flickering glare sources ● Developed focus mechanic (Mar 4) - prompted the initial mechanic, built out full functionality and bug fixed. Hold F highlights platforms within 200px, slows movement to 30%, 1.5s fade, 3.5s cooldown indicator ● Visual + Increased Difficulty (Mar 4) - prompted, refined, built, and bug fixed: moving platforms, enemies, wall-jump mechanic, and variable jump height. Visual update (new assets, character + background effects, enemy interactions, HUD) done by group in-person ● Final Iteration before showcase (Mar 5) - prompted, refined, built, and bug fixed: enemy stacking (if two enemies stack, platform becomes easier) and updated focus mechanic (held action, increased vision range, usable only while standing still on a platform). Visual redesign of menu, Jamie running and jumping animations, and dash bar repositioning done by group online

Human Decision Point(s)	I went and modified the generated code after each prompt to fit the intended mechanics and fix bugs when GenAI solutions didn't work as intended. The intro sequence and win condition were built with the group in-person without prompting. Added Jamie + Ideation (Mar 5) was done manually - spike and laser traps, dash mechanic, Jamie idle sprites, WASD controls, moving platform sticking fix, and the procedural level generator were all added by me without a prompt. I also chose to replace the Dash mechanic with Double Jump after playtesting because it was easier for new players to pick up. The static level after playtesting was my call after the procedural generator caused performance issues.
Integrity & Verification Note:	All generated code was tested in the browser and verified through repeated playtesting. Every commit shows 3/3 GitHub Actions checks passing. Nothing was pushed directly from a prompt without being tested first.
Scope of GenAI Use:	GenAI did not design the game concept, the level design, the intro sequence, the win condition, the Jamie + Ideation additions, the bg-music, difficulty balancing, or the bug fixes. The intro sequence and win condition were done with the group. The Jamie additions, procedural generator, playtesting revisions, checkpoint system, and all final polish commits were done by me independently.
Limitations or Misfires:	GenAI could not account for difficulty balance or the moving platform player-sticking bug, both of which needed manual fixes. The procedural level generator it helped build in the Jamie + Ideation phase caused performance issues that required a full replacement in Playtesting Revisions 1. Code auto-compaction due to storage limits meant I couldn't save full source files, so the commit history is the main record.
Summary of Process (Human + Tool)	During the process of building the game, I would test each phase in the browser, identify issues, and refine before committing. While GenAI supported early coding efficiency, I guided the mechanics, difficulty, and all iterations. The intro sequence and win condition were done with the group in-person. The Jamie additions on Mar 5 were all manual. Post-playtesting I replaced the procedural generator with a static hand-designed level and added the checkpoint system on Mar 11, finishing with minor bug fixes before the showcase.

Decision Points & Trade-offs	● Never pushed generated code directly - every phase was tested and refined before it hit main ● Replaced the Dash mechanic with Double Jump after playtesting - easier for new players to pick up ● Replaced the procedural generator with a static level after playtesting showed it caused performance issues ● Added checkpoints late on Mar 11 after identifying them as a needed fix from playtesting feedback - had to quick fix the same day before showcase
Verification & Judgement	All builds were verified in-browser. Every commit shows 3/3 GitHub Actions checks passing. I tested internally before the Mar 5 playtesting session and used the feedback to drive Playtesting Revisions 1 on Mar 10. Confirmed working in Google Chrome on GitHub Pages before final submission on Mar 12.
Limitations, Dead Ends, or Open Questions	Code couldn't be saved in full due to storage auto-compaction, so the commit history is the main record. The checkpoint system was added late on Mar 11 which left limited time to test - the quick fix commit the same day shows this. The "I lied - Before Showcase" commit was just bg-music and a minor menu colour adjustment, not a scope change.

Entry 3	
Name	**Cameron Emsley-Drummond**
Role(s)	Writing Lead, Presenter (Shadow)
Primary responsibility	In-game text, process documentation, narrative framing of the disability topic
Goal of Work Session	My goal was to establish the visual design and overall feel of the game, making sure the low visibility disability topic was communicated clearly and accessibly through design choices. As AI Verification shadow, I was also responsible for confirming that all GenAI usage across the group was properly documented before submission.

Tools, Resources, or Inputs Used	• A2 assignment brief and README requirements • Lecture notes on empathy-driven design and representation • Group discussions and course concepts around disability representation

Entry 3 — (GenAI Documentation)	
Name	**Cameron Emsley-Drummond**
No GenAI was used for my role. All written content, in-game text, and process documentation were produced independently using course concepts, group discussions, and the A2 assignment brief.	
Summary of Process (Human + Tool)	I developed the in-game text and narrative framing of the low visibility experience, making sure the writing supported the game's goal of fostering empathy without delivering an explicit educational message or invoking pity. I drew on course concepts and group discussions rather than external disability research to shape the written content. I also handled process documentation and reflection writing, which according to the charter was a core Writing Lead responsibility. I coordinated written content with Jason's development timeline so it could be integrated into the build before the playtesting and showcase deadlines.
Decision Points & Trade-offs	Key writing decisions included how to frame the low visibility experience through in-game language - balancing clarity for players unfamiliar with the disability against authenticity to the lived experience. Cameron also made decisions about what written content was essential for the game versus what belonged in the README or process documentation, and prioritized accordingly given the tight development timeline.
Verification & Judgement	I verified design choices by referencing Celeste as a benchmark for how games represent visual disability accessibly, and checking that visual decisions aligned with course concepts around empathy-driven design and avoiding harmful representation. Playtesting feedback was also used to assess whether players were understanding and responding to the visual design as intended.

Limitations, Dead Ends, or Open Questions	One limitation was the tight development timeline, which meant some written content had to be deprioritized or kept shorter than intended. Coordinating writing with Jason's build schedule also required flexibility, as the final text sometimes needed adjusting after seeing how the game was coming together.

Entry 4	
Name	**Cohen Peters**
Role(s)	Design Lead, AI Verification (Shadow)
Primary responsibility	Visual design, game feel, disability representation through design choices, and verifying all GenAI usage is documented
Goal of Work Session	My goal was to handle all written content for A2 - including in-game text, process documentation, and the narrative framing of the low visibility topic. As Writing Lead, I was responsible for making sure written content was ready before the build was finalized so it could be integrated properly by Jason, as outlined in the charter.
Tools, Resources, or Inputs Used	• p5.js drawing tools / asset pipeline • Design references for disability representation • [GenAI tool if used - see GenAI Documentation below] • Celeste (design reference for visual disability representation in games)

Entry 4 — (GenAI Documentation)	
Name	**Cohen Peters**
No GenAI was used for my role. All written content, in-game text, and process documentation were produced independently using course concepts, group discussions, and the A2 assignment brief.	

Summary of Process (Human + Tool)	I was responsible for the visual design language of the game - determining how the low visibility experience would be represented visually in a way that fosters empathy without invoking pity or stereotyping. I communicated design decisions early to Jason so they could be implemented without last-minute changes, as specified in the charter. My shadow role as AI Verification meant I also reviewed all group members' GenAI documentation sections before the final submission to confirm everything was accounted for.
Decision Points & Trade-offs	Key design decisions involved how to visually represent low visibility in a way that is authentic to the disability experience while remaining engaging as a game. Celeste served as a reference point for how a game can represent accessibility-related challenges visually without relying on external research. This informed choices around colour palette, contrast levels, and visual effects - connecting directly to Jason's Low vision world effect commit - and how the design reinforces the focus mechanic rather than working against it. I also had to determine how much design complexity was realistic given the development timeline.
Verification & Judgement	I verified design choices by referencing Celeste as a benchmark for how games represent visual disability accessibly, and checking that visual decisions aligned with course concepts around empathy-driven design and avoiding harmful representation. Playtesting feedback was also used to assess whether players were understanding and responding to the visual design as intended.
Limitations, Dead Ends, or Open Questions	Some visual ideas had to be simplified given the development timeline. Communicating design specs to Jason early helped avoid last-minute changes, but there were still adjustments needed once mechanics were implemented.

GenAI Documentation Summary (Group Level)

The following is a summary of all GenAI usage across the group for A2.

Team Charter Review - Claude Sonnet 4.6 (Jason Pham)

- **Date:** February 25, 2026
- **Tool:** Claude Sonnet 4.6 (Anthropic)
- **Purpose:** To review the A1 team charter and provide suggestions for updating it to meet A2 requirements, then to draft an updated charter with A2-specific milestones, role weights, and GitHub workflow.
- **Outcome:** Claude flagged role weight shifts for A2 (dev-heavy versus A1's equal distribution), GitHub workflow gaps, milestone checkpoint needs, and mandatory attendance re-acknowledgement. The group reviewed these suggestions and adopted those that added value; repetitive or irrelevant suggestions were discarded. Most final charter decisions were made by the group.
- **Prompt Author:** Jason Pham
- **Limitation:** The tool frequently repeated ideas already present in the charter and suggested content that didn't apply to our group's situation.

Concept Development - Cyberpunk Theme (ChatGPT)

- **Date:** February 27, 2026
- **Tool:** ChatGPT (version not specified)
- **Purpose:** To develop the cyberpunk visual theme and narrative concept, adapting the low visibility mechanic into a sci-fi setting.
- **Outcome:** The cyberpunk theme and Jamie character were adopted. All puzzle mechanics proposed were discarded; the game remained a pure platformer. The focus mechanic was adjusted from full immobility to usable only while standing still on a platform.
- **Prompt Author:** Emerson Sanchez
- **Transcript link:** https://chatgpt.com/share/69b231a8-1a00-8004-a7cb-c62df895a66f

p5.js Code Development - Phases 1–7 (Claude Sonnet 4.6 / Opus 4.6)

- **Dates:** March 4–5, 2026 (Phases 1–6); March 10, 2026 (Phase 7)
- **Tool:** Claude Sonnet 4.6 / Opus 4.6 (Anthropic)
- **Purpose:** To generate and consolidate p5.js code across 7 structured phases targeting specific mechanics: base platformer, low vision effect, focus mechanic, intro sequence, enemies and traps, visual overhaul, and static level + performance optimization.
- **Outcome:** Jason refined, bug-fixed, and tested each phase's output before committing. Key human revisions include replacing Dash with Double Jump, adjusting the focus mechanic, adding enemy stacking, and replacing the procedural generator with a hand-designed static level after playtesting. Several commits were completed with the group in-person or online.
- **Prompt Author:** Jason Pham
- **Transcript link:** See Appendix

Sections with No GenAI Usage

- Project Coordination (Emerson Sanchez) - See Concept Development entry above
- Visual Design (Cohen Peters) - No GenAI used

- Written Content / In-Game Text (Cameron Emsley-Drummond) - No GenAI used

Appendix

Full GenAI transcripts are included below for transparency and verification.

Transcript 1: Team Charter Review - Jason Pham

Prompt: "based on our current a1 team charter and assignment 2 is there anything we would need to update? we as a team are currently working well and responding to messages within a reasonable time. anything to improve to ensure we can effectively complete assignments on time?"

Summary: Claude identified role weight shifts for A2 (dev-heavy), GitHub workflow gaps, milestone checkpoint needs, and mandatory attendance re-acknowledgement. A follow-up prompt asked Claude to generate a revised charter with specific milestones, attendance requirements, and an updated GitHub workflow section. Claude provided structural recommendations; all final content and decisions were made by the group.

What We Used or Changed: Adopted some suggestions around milestone structure and GitHub workflow framing. Discarded repetitive content that restated what was already in the A1 charter. Most final charter language was written independently by the group.

Transcript 2: Concept Development - Emerson Sanchez

Link: https://chatgpt.com/share/69b231a8-1a00-8004-a7cb-c62df895a66f

Prompt: "With this information could you make it a more cyberpunk like-theme?"

Summary: ChatGPT generated a full cyberpunk concept including the Jamie character, Charles Abalask story, cyberpunk visual theme, and network manipulation puzzle ideas. The group adopted the theme and Jamie's name; all puzzle mechanics and the full narrative were discarded as out of scope. The focus mechanic was adjusted from full player immobility to usable only while standing still.

Transcript 3: p5.js Code Development - Jason Pham

Link: See GitHub commit history:
https://github.com/j8pham/A2_Group9A_MidTermGame/commits/main/

Prompts used (by phase):

- Phase 1: "Build a p5.js side-scrolling platformer. The player moves left and right with arrow keys and jumps with the up arrow key. Include gravity and collision detection with static rectangular platforms. Canvas is 800x450. Add 7 platforms at varied heights. Player should not fall through platforms. No visual effects yet."
- Phase 2: "Add a persistent low vision visual effect to the p5.js platformer. All platforms and background elements should render at low opacity (0.2 to 0.3) by default, making them hard to distinguish. Add a dark radial vignette that permanently darkens the screen edges. Add 2 or 3 background light sources like flickering rectangles that pulse in brightness to simulate harsh glare competing with the platforms visually. The world should feel poorly lit and hard to navigate, not like a damaged screen."
- Phase 3: "Add a Focus mechanic to the p5.js platformer. When the player holds F, platforms within 200px of the player highlight to full opacity with a faint cyan neon outline. Player movement slows to 30% of normal speed while F is held. When F is released, the highlights fade over 1.5 seconds. After releasing F, Focus cannot be used

again for 3.5 seconds. Show the cooldown state with a small indicator below the player. This represents visual concentration as a limited and tiring resource."

- Phase 4: "Add a short intro sequence before gameplay starts. For the first 2 seconds the player moves normally with full platform visibility and no vignette. Then trigger a screen shake lasting 0.5 seconds followed by a brief white flash. After the flash, permanently switch to the low vision visual state for the rest of the level."
- Phase 5: “Add one patrol enemy that moves left and right between two points on a platform. The enemy is rendered at the same low opacity as the rest of the world so it is affected by the same visual limitation. If the player touches the enemy, reset the player to the starting position. No health system, just a positional reset.”
- Phase 6: “I am building a p5.js side-scrolling platformer called Data Breach. Below is my current code built across multiple phases. Please consolidate everything into one clean, complete, and bug-free sketch.js file while also going all out on the visual design. The game must include all of the following working together: basic platformer movement with gravity and collision, a persistent low vision visual effect where platforms are dim by default with a dark edge vignette and flickering background glare sources, a Focus mechanic where holding F slows the player and highlights nearby platforms with a cyan outline but has a 3.5 second cooldown after release shown by a small indicator below the player, a short intro sequence where the player moves normally for 2 seconds then a screen shake and white flash permanently transitions to the low vision state, and one patrol enemy that resets the player to start on contact. For the visual overhaul go as creative as possible within p5.js. Use a deep cyberpunk noir color palette of blacks, dark purples, electric blues, hot pinks and neon greens. Add a parallax scrolling background with at least 2 layers of distant city silhouettes. Add floating particle effects like drifting sparks or rain. Make platforms look like glowing geometric neon constructs with subtle edge glow even at low opacity. When Focus activates make it feel dramatic with a ripple or pulse effect radiating from the player. Add a scanline overlay across the entire canvas to reinforce the glitchy AR aesthetic. Make the player character visually distinct with a neon accent glow silhouette. The world should feel like a beautiful broken city that is genuinely hard to navigate, not just a grey blurry screen. Remove any redundant or conflicting code from combining the phases.” Prompted to Opus 4.6.
- Phase 7: “Update Data Breach to use a single hand-designed static level instead of any procedural or dynamic level generation. Hard-code all platform positions, enemy patrol points, hazard locations, checkpoint positions, and the goal object into the setup function. Remove all generation logic completely. The static level should still have a clear difficulty curve from start to finish with the vision zones, light strips, and wall hazard all placed deliberately. Additionally optimize the entire sketch for performance: remove any redundant draw calls, make sure particle systems have a hard cap on maximum particles, avoid creating new objects inside the draw loop, and pre-calculate anything that does not need to update every frame. The game should run smoothly on a large 1920x1080 display at stable framerates. Produce one complete clean sketch.js file.”

Summary: Claude generated initial code output for each phase. All testing, bug-fixing, feature refinement, and final integration decisions were made by Jason. Key human changes: replaced Dash with Double Jump, adjusted Focus to standing-still-only use, added enemy stacking logic, replaced procedural generator with a static hand-designed level after playtesting revealed performance issues.